

Justin Bell

justin@justinbell.me | justinbell.me | linkedin.com/in/jbell7 | Los Angeles, CA

WORK EXPERIENCE

Product Engineering & Independent Projects

Senior Software Engineer & Product Builder

Los Angeles, CA | Jan 2025 - Present

- Built Sideline Reels (sideline-reels.vercel.app), a human-in-the-loop soccer video product that transforms parent-recorded footage into player-highlighted recruiting reels using Next.js and TypeScript, a Modal-hosted YOLO11/ByteTrack tracking service, and ffmpeg telestration
- Designed Sideline Reels' durable media pipeline spanning resumable direct-to-R2 uploads, Trigger.dev orchestration for normalization, tracking, rendering, and multi-clip reel assembly, plus privacy-first deletion cascades for source footage and derived assets
- Architected, launched, and independently operated GameRelish (gamerelish.com), a community feedback platform live since July 2025, with 41+ row-level security policies, layered abuse prevention, optimistic React Query updates, email automation, and 250+ automated tests

AI Product Company (Confidential; NDA bound)

Senior Software Engineer (Contract)

Los Angeles, CA | Dec 2025 - Mar 2026

- Delivered production AI-driven features across multiple full-stack TypeScript applications using React, Node.js, and GraphQL, with rapid iteration and strong automated test coverage

The Washington Post (Arc XP)

Senior Software Engineer / Software Engineer (Promoted Apr 2023)

Los Angeles, CA | Dec 2019 - Dec 2024

- Led React rebuild of WebSked's List View, replacing legacy AngularJS architecture to improve maintainability and scalability
- Architected an organization-wide, config-free user authorization system in Node.js, reducing admin support tickets by >40%
- Built REST APIs, automation tooling and DynamoDB schemas supporting fine-grained role-based access control
- Authored the solution design for Featured Media in Arc's highest-traffic customer app, flagging critical bottlenecks pre-build
- Ensured internationalization compliance (i18n) and RTL support for SLA-bound applications
- Maintained CI/CD pipelines and AWS cloud infrastructure; rotated through 24/7 on-call support for incident response across SLA-bound applications
- Led cross-functional training sessions on Arc XP's core request-routing, authentication, and authorization systems, enabling technical and nontechnical colleagues to work more confidently across the platform

EDUCATION

Hack Reactor / Telegraph Academy - Software Engineering Immersive (2016)

Dartmouth College - BA in Sociology (2012)

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL, Tailwind, NestJS

Backend & Data: REST APIs, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Supabase, Firebase, Redis, row-level security

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Cloudflare R2, Docker, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Trigger.dev, Modal

Applied AI & Media: Computer vision integration, GPU inference workflows, ffmpeg, human-in-the-loop system design

Testing: Jest, Cypress, Chai

INTERESTS

Music Production, Physical Fitness, Fiction Writing, Nature, Community Impact, Lakers, Dodgers, Philadelphia Eagles, Food (cooking & eating)